

Homebrew Tap Manual

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Homebrew Tap

The Homebrew formula that lets users `brew install preston-check`. A separate repo from the main one because Homebrew expects taps to be their own repos.

Repo

`https://github.com/preston-check/homebrew-tap`

Installing from the tap (end user)

```
brew trust --tap preston-check/tap
brew tap preston-check/tap
brew install preston-check
```

`brew trust` is required from Homebrew 6.0 onwards. `$HOMEBREW_REQUIRE_TAP_TRUST` defaults to true, and an untrusted non-official tap is refused at load time with `Refusing to load formula ... from untrusted tap`, which `brew tap` then reports as `Cannot tap preston-check/tap: invalid syntax in tap!`. That message names neither trust nor the real cause and reads like a broken formula; it is not. Trust must precede the tap, because the tap is the step that fails.

There is an escape hatch, `$HOMEBREW_NO_REQUIRE_TAP_TRUST`, but upstream marks it “not recommended and will be removed in a later release”, so neither this manual nor the release pipeline uses it.

The tap serves Apple Silicon macOS 15 and 26 and x86_64 Linux — the platforms `release.yml` declares in `EXPECTED_BOTTLE_TAGS` and builds bottles for. macOS 11 through 14 and every Intel Mac are Homebrew support tier 3, where bottles are no longer published for Preston-Check or for its

`bash`, `coreutils`, `gawk` and `grep` dependencies; `brew install` refuses there rather than building, so those users take `install.sh` instead. Point anyone on a tier 3 machine at `curl -fsSL https://get.preston-check.com/install.sh | sh`.

After the first install, future updates land via:

```
brew update && brew upgrade preston-check
```

What's in the tap

```
homebrew-tap/
Formula/
  preston-check.rb    the only formula in the tap
README.md            tap installation notes (visible to users)
LICENSE              Apache 2.0
```

The formula at `Formula/preston-check.rb` is a Ruby class extending `Formula`. Three fields change per release: `url`, `sha256`, `version`. Everything else is stable.

How it gets bumped

Two paths.

Auto-bump (preferred) — The `release.yml` workflow in the main repo has a `homebrew` job that runs after a successful release. It checks out the tap repo using a `HOME BREW_TAP_TOKEN` secret (a PAT with write access to the tap), rewrites `url` / `sha256` / `version` in the formula, commits, and pushes. End-to-end ~30 seconds after the release fires.

The PAT is scoped to "Contents: Write" on the homebrew-tap repo only. Set as a repo secret named `HOME BREW_TAP_TOKEN` in the main preston-check repo (Settings → Secrets and variables → Actions).

Manual bump (fallback) — If `HOME BREW_TAP_TOKEN` isn't set or the auto-bump fails:

```
SHA=$(curl -fsSL https://github.com/preston-check/preston-check/releases/download/vX.Y.Z/preston-check-X.Y.Z.tar.gz.sha256 | awk '{print $1}')
git clone https://github.com/preston-check/homebrew-tap /tmp/hb
cd /tmp/hb

# Edit Formula/preston-check.rb – change url, sha256, version
# Or use a one-liner via Python:
```

```
python3 - <<EOF
import re, pathlib
p = pathlib.Path("Formula/preston-check.rb")
src = p.read_text()
src = re.sub(r'url ".*?"', 'url "https://github.com/preston-check/preston-check/releases/download/vX.Y.Z/preston-check-X.Y.Z.tar.gz"', src, count=1)
src = re.sub(r'sha256 ".*?"', f'sha256 "$SHA"', src, count=1)
src = re.sub(r'version ".*?"', 'version "X.Y.Z"', src, count=1)
p.write_text(src)
EOF

git add Formula/preston-check.rb
git commit -m "preston-check X.Y.Z"
git push
```

Formula structure

```
class PrestonCheck < Formula
  desc "Pre-deployment security audit for fintech and financial systems"
  homepage "https://preston-check.com"
  url "https://github.com/preston-check/preston-check/releases/download/v1.7.5/preston-check-1.7.5.tar.gz"
  sha256 "<sha256-of-release-tarball>"
  license "Apache-2.0"
  version "1.7.5"

  depends_on "bash"
  depends_on "openssl@3"
  depends_on "gawk"
  depends_on "grep"
  depends_on "coreutils"

  def install
    libexec.install Dir["*"]
    (bin/"preston-check").write <<~SH
    #!/bin/bash
    exec "#{libexec}/preston-check.sh" "$@"
  SH
    chmod 0755, bin/"preston-check"
  end

  def caveats
    <<~EOS
    Preston-Check is installed. Free tier runs without any setup.
  EOS
end
```

To run a scan in the current directory:
preston-check

Documentation: <https://preston-check.com>

```
EOS
end

test do
  assert_match "preston-check", shell_output("#{bin}/preston-check --version")
end
end
```

Verifying after a bump

```
# Force-update the tap's local cache and try install
brew untap preston-check/tap 2>/dev/null
brew trust --tap preston-check/tap
brew tap preston-check/tap
brew install preston-check
preston-check --version
# Should print: preston-check 1.7.5 (or whatever the new version is)
```

Audit trail

Every formula bump becomes a commit on the homebrew-tap repo's master branch. Easy to inspect:

`git log Formula/preston-check.rb` shows every version change with timestamp and message.

When something goes wrong

Install fails with sha256 mismatch — the release tarball was modified after the formula was bumped (unlikely; GitHub doesn't mutate published artifacts) or the formula has the wrong sha256. Pull the actual sha from the release sidecar and update.

Install fails with download error — the release URL doesn't exist yet. The auto-bump may have raced ahead of GitHub's CDN propagation; wait 1-2 min and retry.

Tap returns 404 on tap — the tap repo was renamed or made private. Verify

`https://github.com/preston-check/homebrew-tap` loads.

Cross-links

- **GitHub Release manual:** `docs/manuals/github-release.md`
- **Operator runbook** (manual bump procedure): `docs/operator-runbook.md`
- **Administrator manual** (release flow): `docs/manuals/administrator-manual.md`